had much to do with the tragic death of his wife, Ferdi, a Dutch artist and frequent collaborator, in a household accident in February 1969. A week before her death, the letter of invitation arrived from West Berlin but was ignored. Months later, when searching for his next steps, he rediscovered the letter. He decided to take intermittent time away from large sculptural works while mourning Ferdi and turn to the teaching position in West Berlin to support his family.



FIGURE 3.1 Shinkichi Tajiri in his West Berlin studio, ca. 1969. (Shinkichi Tajiri Estate)

For his first meeting with administrators, Tajiri drove his speedy white Lotus Elan 2 from Baarlo to West Berlin. There he encountered the Wall and was immediately intrigued. He later recalled, “Once in the city center, I began to feel a low throbbing vibration, like a transformer plugged into the mains supply, but without a machine to relieve the current load. Driving